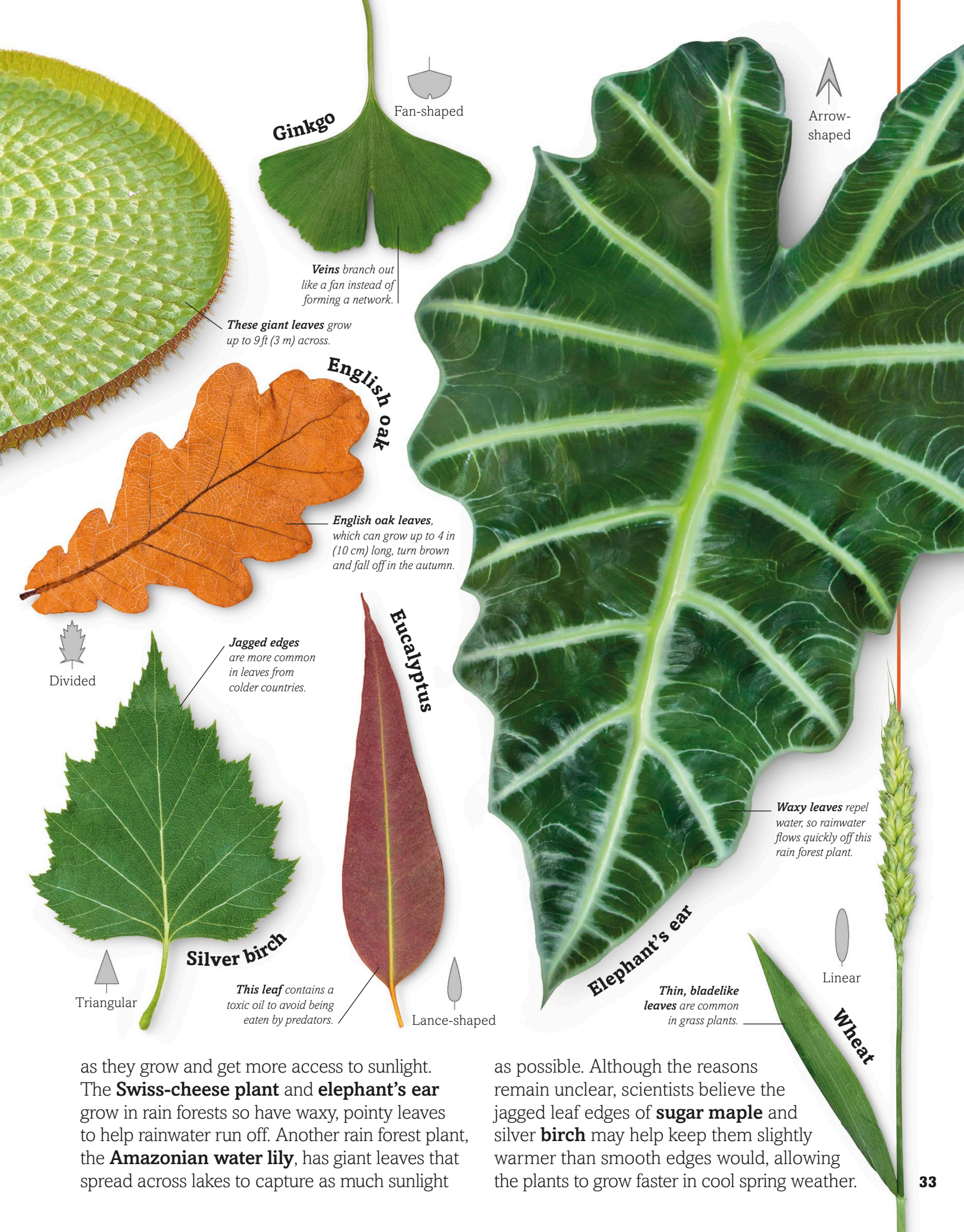




Ginkgo

Fan-shaped

Veins branch out like a fan instead of forming a network.

These giant leaves grow up to 9 ft (3 m) across.

English oak

English oak leaves, which can grow up to 4 in (10 cm) long, turn brown and fall off in the autumn.

Divided

Jagged edges are more common in leaves from colder countries.

Silver birch

Triangular

This leaf contains a toxic oil to avoid being eaten by predators.

Eucalyptus

Lance-shaped

Elephant's ear

Thin, blade-like leaves are common in grass plants.

Arrow-shaped

Waxy leaves repel water, so rainwater flows quickly off this rain forest plant.

Linear

Wheat

as they grow and get more access to sunlight. The **Swiss-cheese plant** and **elephant's ear** grow in rain forests so have waxy, pointy leaves to help rainwater run off. Another rain forest plant, the **Amazonian water lily**, has giant leaves that spread across lakes to capture as much sunlight

as possible. Although the reasons remain unclear, scientists believe the jagged leaf edges of **sugar maple** and silver **birch** may help keep them slightly warmer than smooth edges would, allowing the plants to grow faster in cool spring weather.